

1. ChatGPT search now uses the site:operator at scale

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-20T23:57:32+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/20/chatgpt-search-now-uses-the-siteoperator-at-scale/>

ChatGPT search now uses the site:operator at scale Promptwatch is part of the emerging "GEO" space, for Generative Engine Optimization - the chatbot version of SEO, where companies offer tools and consulting to help your site increase its presence in replies to prompts inside tools like ChatGPT. The Promptwatch product uses automation to track responses to prompts across end-user chat products like ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini. They publish aggregate reports on this as part of their own content marketing strategy, which do seem to provide credible hints as to otherwise invisible design changes to those products. Their own tracking shows a notable change aligned with the GPT-5.6 rollout earlier this month: The percentage of all ChatGPT Search fanout queries that contain the site:operator, per day. The share hovered between 0.3% and 0.5% for weeks, dipped briefly to 0.15% on August 3 to 5 (consistent with a staged rollout or pre-launch experiment), then jumped to 16-17% on August 8. It's important to note that these figures only reflect the prompts for which they have automated tracking enabled. This corresponds to OpenAI's somewhat vague August 6th announcement : For Plus and Pro us...

2. A shot-scraper-style JSON API on Bun 1.4's new Bun.WebView

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-20T15:37:00+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/20/bun-webview-json-api/>

Research: A shot-scraper-style JSON API on Bun 1.4's new Bun.WebView Today saw the long awaited release of Bun 1.4 , the first stable version since the infamous Rust rewrite a few months ago

. Interestingly, the Rust rewrite was downplayed in the release notes, which introduced a bewildering array of new features and claimed 2,900 additional bug fixes: Bun 1.4 adds +1,517 tests from the Node.js test suite - our biggest jump in Node.js compatibility since Bun 1.0.

Bun v1.4 also fixes over 2,900 issues. It reduces idle CPU usage by 5x, reduces memory usage by up to 35%, and starts 50% faster on Linux. It adds Bun.Image , Bun.WebView , Bun.markdown , Bun.cron() , Bun.Terminal , bun run --parallel , bun test --parallel , bun audit fix , bun dedupe , and bun prune . And it rewrites Bun from Zig to Rust. Of these the one that most caught my eye was Bun.WebView , which adds first class support for browser automation to Bun core using either macOS WebKit or control of a local Chromium process via the Chrome DevTools Protocol (CDP). I had Claude Code for web build a prototype of a web API providing the ability to load a web page and then execute JavaScript against it, inspired by my shot-s...

3. Quoting Claude Opus 5 system prompt

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-09T23:31:39+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/9/claude-opus-5-system-prompt/>

Claude Fable 5 and Claude Mythos 5 were first released on June 9, 2026. On June 12, 2026, Anthropic suspended access to both models to comply with U.S. Department of Commerce export controls; the Department lifted those controls on June 30, 2026, and Anthropic restored access on July 1, 2026 (Anthropic's statement: <https://www.anthropic.com/news/fable-mythos-access>). These events are after Claude's training-data cutoff, so Claude knows about them only from this notice. If asked, Claude confirms them accurately and matter-of-factly ? it doesn't deny the suspension happened ? and otherwise treats the export controls like any other current political topic: it gives a fair, accurate account rather than sharing personal opinions, and points to the linked statement for anything further. Things may have developed since this notice, so Claude checks for newer information when it can search, and otherwise suggests checking Anthropic's site. ? Claude Opus 5 system prompt , ensuring Claude doesn't provide incorrect answers about the export controls situation Tags: system-prompts , anthropic , claude , generative-ai , ai , llms , claude-mythos-fable

4. Getting the Steam Deck LCD working on a Raspberry Pi

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Thu, 20 Aug 2026 09:00:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/steam-deck-lcd-pi-hat/>

The BOE TV070WXM-TV0 LCD used in the original Steam Deck can be had for around \$30. It's a serviceable 7" touchscreen with 400 nits of brightness and a resolution of 1280x800 (for a sharp 216 ppi). The specs are a lot nicer than the Pi 7" Touch Display, which costs twice as much, with giant bezels and half the resolution! Until today, the Steam Deck LCD didn't work with a Raspberry Pi. But the folks at Scandent were trying to standardize on a mass-market touchscreen for one of their own devices, and built a Linux kernel driver for it which they intend to upstream.

5. MacOS 26.7 Tahoe Release Candidate Contains a Video Demonstrating Camera-Equipped AirPods in Action

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-18T03:37:14Z

Link: <https://www.macrumors.com/2026/08/17/camera-equipped-airpods-macos-26-7/>

Oops. ?

6. Trump Administration ?Not in Favor? of Apple Using Chinese RAM

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-16T16:34:12Z

Link: <https://www.wsj.com/tech/apple-china-memory-chip-plan-57773a83?st=vfe1SA>

The Wall Street Journal (gift link): To help alleviate the supply crunch, Apple is looking to Chinese manufacturers. ?The Trump administration is not in favor of that,? Lutnick said in an interview after touring an Apple manufacturing facility in Houston. There have to be ?other solutions to the memory issue, but it?s not great American companies using Chinese memory.? Asked if he has relayed that message to Apple, Lutnick said ?plainly.? But: U.S. government rules require American companies to secure a license before sharing product information with CXMT and YMTC. The Chinese chip makers would need such information if they were to make customized chips for Apple. But Apple is free to buy off-the-shelf parts from the companies, and to negotiate prices with them. Apple?s chief operating officer, Sabih Khan, declined to confirm that Apple was testing Chinese memory chips in an interview Thursday. But he said that given the magnitude of the supply shortage, ?we have to look at all options,? including working with existing suppliers to increase U.S. production. ?

7. XCancel ? An Unofficial Twitter/X Mirror

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-16T14:33:16Z

Link: <https://xcancel.com/about>

XCancel: XCancel is an instance of Nitter. Nitter is a free and open source alternative Twitter front-end focused on privacy and performance. The source is available on GitHub at <https://github.com/zedeus/nitter> [...] Using an instance of Nitter (hosted on a VPS for example), you can browse Twitter without JavaScript while retaining your privacy. In addition to respecting your privacy, Nitter is on average around 15 times lighter than Twitter, and in most cases serves pages faster (eg. timelines load 2-4×faster). I personally don?t care for Elon Musk?s X-rebranded Twitter. I also realize that some of you outright despise it, and, worse, that under Musk, they make it difficult to view content if you?re not signed into an account or if you have JavaScript disabled. So, sometimes, when I link to posts or threads on Twitter/X, I include a link to the same content at XCancel. XCancel isn?t perfect, alas. Just this week I linked to a tweet from Google Design that contained an animation of an Android app that they were inexplicably proud to show off. The XCancel cache of that tweet only showed it as animated to some people. Others just saw a static image. I don?t know why. That?s XCance...

8. On wrapping a callable in a lambda that just calls it with the same parameters

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 19 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260819-00/?p=112624>

Just use the callable directly. The post On wrapping a callable in a lambda that just calls it with the same parameters appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. AI-generated ASCII diagrams

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 20 Aug 2026 13:48:43 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/20/ai-generated-ascii-diagrams/>

I like AI-generated ASCII diagrams. Because nobody would ask AI to generate ASCII diagrams, and so, it's congruous. I like incongruity [1]. Aside from the incongruity of using a gazillion-parameter neural network to make 1970's style ASCII art, ASCII diagrams have some uses. They're absolutely tiny compared to image files. But more importantly they can [?] The post AI-generated ASCII diagrams first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Better Batteries

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-08-20T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/08/20/better-batteries.html>

One of the eternal schisms in programming is over the question of whether the standard library should be minimal or encompassing. This is the wrong question to ask. The right one is:

11. Issues in the Repo

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-20T09:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/20/issues-in-the-repo.html>

GitHub had a rough Monday this week, with git operations, Actions, and the issue tracker all unavailable for several hours . Code being unreachable during a forge outage is annoying but survivable because every contributor already has a full clone. Issues and pull request threads going dark is a different matter, since for most projects those exist only in GitHub's database and nowhere else. I asked on Mastodon about tools that keep issue and review data inside the repository so it clones and pushes with the code, and got pointed at more projects than I expected, spanning about twenty years of people having a go at this. The projects sort by where they physically put the data, and each storage location brings its own answers to the same handful of questions: whether a plain git clone fetches it, what happens when two people edit the same issue offline and then both push, whether you can read it without the tool installed, whether it survives being pushed to a bare git host that has no support for the tool, and who counts as the author of an issue when there are no forge accounts. I wrote about git's extension points last year and several of these tools use the custom-ref mechanism...

12. Our Servants Will Do That For Us

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Thu, 20 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/our-servants-will-do-that-for-us>

Why the post-scarcity utopia is unlikely.

13. A Sloppy Interface Is a Security Liability ?

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Thu, 20 Aug 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/sloppy-ui-is-security-liability/>

In his talk ?Why AI Is Breaking Software Security As We Know It? (my notes here), Feross Aboukhadijeh talks about the Axios npm incident and how the maintainer got phished by succumbing to (amongst other things) a faux Microsoft Teams interface: this is the kind of thing that AI makes easy to do, because it can vibe code that whole fake Microsoft Teams interface pretty trivially You've probably seen these: interfaces designed to look like some other product in order to provide a facade of authenticity and exploit someone. What struck me in listening to Feross was this idea of how the quality of your interfaces can be a protection mechanism against attackers. I don't know if I've ever heard someone say that out loud ? interface and interaction design as a security control ? but I'm saying it. Now, of course, not everyone will consciously notice the level of polish that world-class professionals imbue in digital interfaces. But some will. Personally, I've always used the quality and care of digital experiences as a heuristic for judging authenticity ? and competency to be honest, e.g. ?If this UI is so bad, what else will surely be bad?? Granted, it was a much more dependable heur...

14. Pluralistic: The actual epistemic crisis (20 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 20 Aug 2026 23:41:21

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Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/20/epistemic-void/>

Today's links The actual epistemic crisis: AI's assault on reality is an opportunistic infection. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Disney goths; Running a con room party; Equation Group's fuggly sourcecode; "Bubble"; "The Weight." Upcoming appearances: Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. The actual epistemic crisis (permalink) AI is alarming for many reasons: it's a dangerous financial bubble, an environmental catastrophe, and a tool for eroding wages and labor power. But in addition to all that, AI is an epistemic disaster. We've had photoshopped images, voice impersonators and visual effects for years, of course, but with deepfakes, we've democratized access to reality-bending images, sounds and videos that appear real but are not. It's harder than ever to know what's true. Politicians and celebrities and activists show up in our feeds, declaring their fealty to this cause or product, or their fury at some turn in the world's events. Battlefields mound high with bodies an...

15. Introducing Dashboard Touch, a build-your-own version of Touch ID

Source: Anil Dash | Published: 2026-08-20T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://anildash.com/2026/08/20/introducing-dashboard-touch/>

For years, I've wanted to have a standalone version of Apple's Touch ID authentication feature for my Mac, but without having to use an Apple keyboard. (I generally like their keyboards, but my daily driver keyboard these days is a big clicky mechanical beast.) I'd gone down various dead ends of trying to find substitutes, and even checked out the efforts where people had ripped apart expensive Apple keyboards just to scavenge the Touch ID sensors out of them. None of them quite solved the problem. So today, I'm sharing an open source project called Dashboard Touch, which lets you make your own Touch ID-style sensor for your Mac, using low-cost off-the-shelf part. It's based on an extensive refactoring of the excellent tinyTouch project by Zimeng Xiong, who recently cracked the code on how to make a useful fingerprint scanner system that's also reasonably secure for regular Mac users. (You should definitely check out his project and support his new hardware build if you're interested in this stuff.) I took my own approach to this work because I wanted to focus a lot on having a friendly web interface for configuring exactly how the fingerprint sensor system works on your computer...